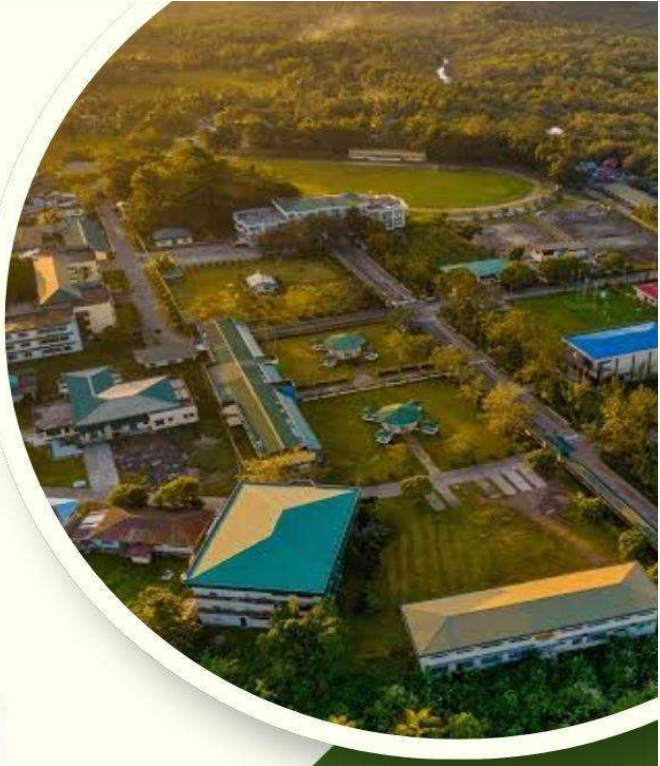
EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY

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SUSTAINABILITY REPORT







3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL BEING

3.2.1: Proportion of Graduates in Health Professions



3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

3.2: Number Graduating in Health Professions

3.2.1: Proportion of Graduates in Health Professions

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates its contribution to the advancement of health professions through its academic programs that prepare graduates for careers in healthcare and related professional fields. In support of Sustainable Development Goal 3 (SDG 3): Good Health and Well-Being, the University recognizes the importance of developing a competent workforce capable of responding to the healthcare needs of communities, particularly in underserved and geographically challenged areas.

For Academic Year 2024–2025, Eastern Samar State University recorded a total of **4,561 graduates** across its five campuses: Borongan, Can-avid, Guiuan, Maydolong, and Salcedo. Of this number, **119 graduates completed health-related academic programs,** consisting of 80 graduates from the Bachelor of Science in Nursing program and 39 graduates from the Diploma in Midwifery program.

These graduates represent approximately **2.61% of the University's total graduating population.** Their completion of health-related academic programs reflects ESSU's contribution to producing individuals equipped with relevant professional knowledge and competencies to support healthcare delivery and maternal and community health services.

The Bachelor of Science in Nursing program contributes to the preparation of nursing professionals who can participate in patient care, health promotion, disease prevention, and community-based healthcare services. Meanwhile, the Diploma in Midwifery program contributes to developing skilled practitioners who support maternal, newborn, and reproductive healthcare, particularly in communities where access to these services remains essential.

The University's five-campus structure further demonstrates its institutional capacity to provide accessible higher education across different localities in Eastern Samar. Through its academic offerings, ESSU helps expand opportunities for professional education while contributing to the development of human resources needed by the health sector.

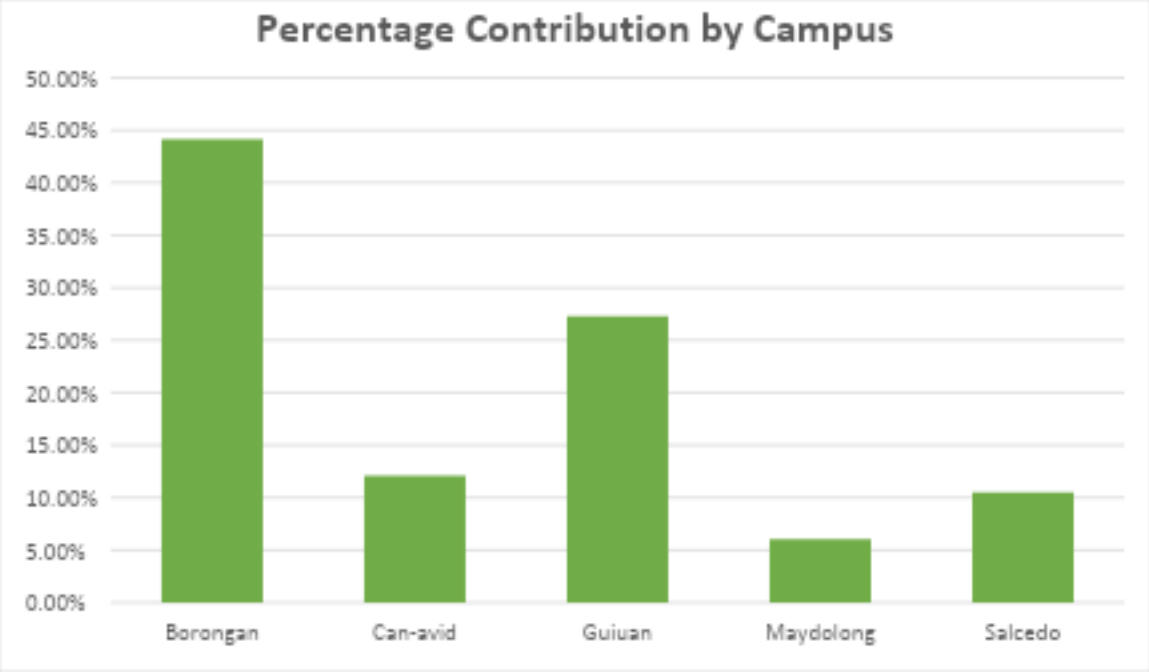
Although health-related graduates account for a relatively small proportion of the University's overall graduates, their contribution is significant because healthcare education addresses specialized workforce requirements that directly affect public health and community well-being. The 119 graduates represent an important addition to the pool of individuals prepared to serve in health-related occupations and contribute to strengthening the healthcare workforce.

I. Distribution, Proportion, and Percentage of Graduates by Campus

Distribution, Proportion, and Percentage of Graduates by Campus, AY 2024–2025

Campus	Graduate Programs	Baccalaureate Programs	Pre-baccalaureate Programs	Total Graduates	Proportion	Percentage
Borongan	219	1,714	80	2,013	0.4413	44.13%
Can-avid	–	550	–	550	0.1206	12.06%
Guiuan	124	1,121	–	1,245	0.2730	27.30%
Maydolong	–	275	–	275	0.0603	6.03%
Salcedo	50	428	–	478	0.1048	10.48%
Total	**393**	**4,088**	**80**	**4,561**	**1.0000**	**100.00%**

Percentage Distribution of Graduates by Campus



Borongan Campus recorded the highest number of graduates, with 2,013, accounting for 44.13% of the University's total graduating population. Guiuan Campus followed with 1,245 graduates, representing 27.30%. Can-avid Campus contributed 550 graduates (12.06%), while Salcedo Campus recorded 478 graduates (10.48%). Maydolong Campus had 275 graduates, equivalent to 6.03% of the institutional total.

The distribution indicates that Borongan and Guiuan campuses collectively produced 3,258 graduates, representing 71.43% of ESSU's total graduates. Meanwhile, the three other campuses collectively contributed 1,303 graduates or 28.57%.

These figures demonstrate the University's broad institutional reach in providing higher education opportunities across Eastern Samar. The distribution also establishes the institutional baseline for determining the proportion of graduates completing health-related academic programs relative to the University's total number of graduates.

For the purpose of measuring the University's contribution to health professions education, the total of 4,561 graduates serves as the institutional denominator in determining the proportion of graduates who receive a degree associated with a health-related profession out of the institution's total number of graduates.

II. Health-Related Academic Programs and Graduates

Number, Proportion, and Percentage of Graduates in Health-Related Academic Programs AY 2024–2025

Health-related Academic Program	Number of Graduate	Proportion	Percentage
BS in Nursing	80	0.6723	67.23%
Diploma in Midwifery	39	0.3277	32.77%
BS in Nutrition and Dietetics	–	–	–
Total	**119**	**1.0000**	**100.00%**

The BS in Nursing program produced 80 graduates, representing 67.23% of all reported health-related graduates. The Diploma in Midwifery program contributed 39 graduates, equivalent to 32.77%.

The results indicate that Nursing is the University's largest contributor to health-related graduate production. Its graduates are prepared with competencies relevant to patient care, health promotion, disease prevention, and community-based healthcare services.

Meanwhile, the Diploma in Midwifery program contributes to the preparation of practitioners who can support maternal, newborn, and reproductive healthcare. This is particularly important in communities where access to maternal and child health services remains a significant consideration.

Together, these programs demonstrate ESSU's contribution to preparing individuals for healthcare-related occupations and strengthening the pool of trained human resources available to support health service delivery.

The BS in Nutrition and Dietetics entry should be verified against the official graduation records to determine whether the program had no graduates during the reporting period or whether the figure was not reported.

III. Institutional Proportion of Graduates in Health Professions

The institutional contribution of ESSU to health professions education is determined by comparing the number of graduates from health-related academic programs with the University's total number of graduates during AY 2024–2025.

Proportion of Health-Related Graduates to Total University Graduates

Indicator	Number	Proportion	Percentage
Total University graduates	4,561	1.0000	100.00%
Health-related graduates	119	0.0261	2.61%
Graduates from other academic programs	4,442	0.9739	97.39%

For AY 2024–2025, ESSU recorded 119 graduates from its reported health-related academic programs out of 4,561 total graduates. This translates to an institutional proportion of **0.0261 or 2.61%.**

This means that approximately three out of every 100 graduates completed a reported health-related academic program. Although health-related graduates constitute a relatively small share of the University's overall graduating population, their contribution is important because they represent individuals prepared for specialized professional roles in the healthcare sector.

The 119 graduates from Nursing and Midwifery contribute to the development of human resources who can support patient care, maternal and newborn health, disease prevention, and community health services. Their professional preparation is particularly relevant to Eastern Samar, where accessible and responsive healthcare services are essential to community development and public well-being.

The remaining 4,442 graduates, representing 97.39% of the University's graduating population, come from other academic disciplines. This reflects ESSU's broad educational

mandate while demonstrating its specific contribution to health professions education through its health-related programs.

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL BEING

3.3.1. COLLABORATIONS WITH HEALTH INSTITUTIONS



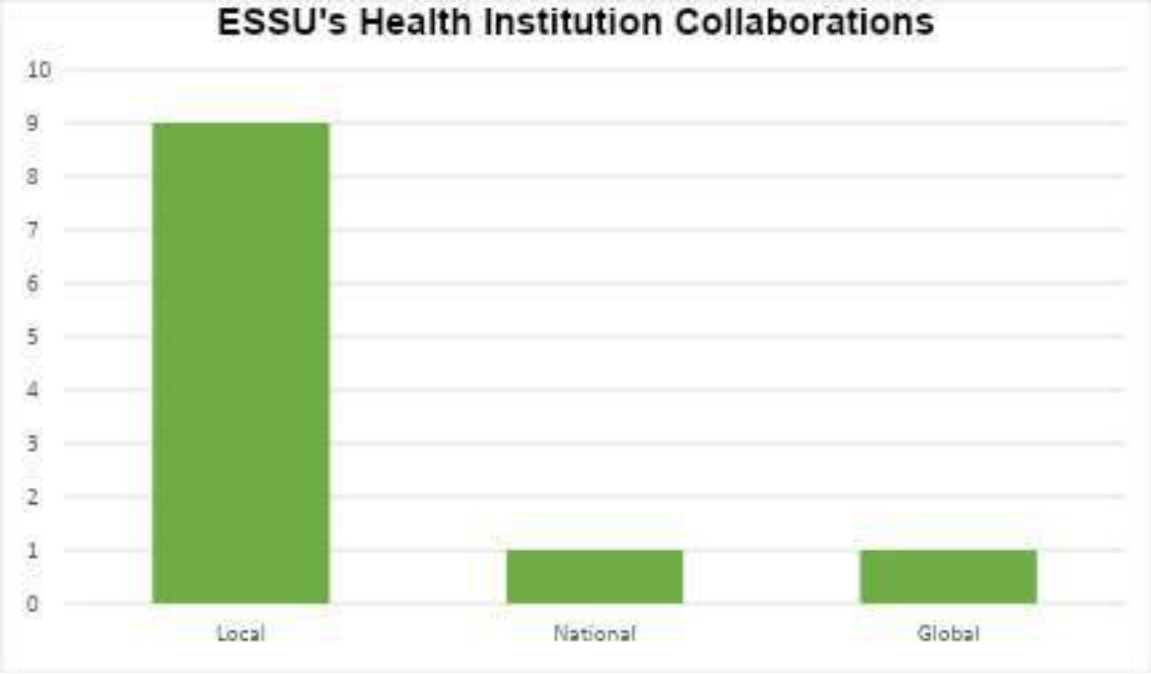
3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

3.3.1. COLLABORATIONS WITH HEALTH INSTITUTIONS

For the Times Higher Education (THE) Sustainability Impact Ratings, ESSU's data demonstrate an established network of 11 health-related institutional collaborations, comprising nine local institutions, one national institution, and one global partner. These partnerships illustrate the University's engagement with health institutions across different geographical levels to support improved health and well-being outcomes.

The strongest feature of the University's collaboration network is its local presence, complemented by national and global partnerships. This reflects ESSU's potential to contribute to accessible healthcare services, community health initiatives, and broader health and well-being programs through institutional cooperation.

I. Distribution of Health Collaborations



Geographical level	Number of institutions	Percentage
Local	9	81.82%
National	1	9.09%

Global	1	9.09%
Total	**11**	**100%**

The distribution indicates that 81.82% of the identified partnerships are with local health institutions, demonstrating the University's emphasis on strengthening its engagement with healthcare providers and institutions within its immediate service areas. Meanwhile, national and global collaborations extend the University's institutional connections beyond the local setting, providing opportunities for broader cooperation in addressing health and well-being concerns.

II. Identified Health Institution Collaborations

The University's collaborations encompass hospitals, medical facilities, rural health centers, and organizations engaged in health-related and social welfare services. Incorporated in the table are the links to evidence.

Geographical Level	Collaborating Institution
Local	Eastern Samar Provincial Hospital (ESPH)
	Immaculate Concepcion Clinic and Hospital
	Ponferrada Polymedic Hospital
	Guiuan Rural Health Center
	Local Government Unit of Borongan City (LGU–Rural Health Center)
	St. Jude Hospital
	Borongan Doctors Hospital (BDH)
	Felipe Abrigo Memorial Hospital
	Local Government Unit of Maydolong (LGU–Rural Health Center)
	Eastern Samar Provincial Hospital (ESPH)
	Immaculate Concepcion Clinic and Hospital
National	Cebu Metro Psychiatry, Inc. (CMPI)
Global	Kkttongnae Philippines, Inc. (Pope Francis Complex Center for the Poor)

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) maintains institutional collaborations with local, national, and global health institutions to improve health and well-being outcomes. These

partnerships demonstrate the University's commitment to supporting healthcare delivery, strengthening community health services, and promoting institutional cooperation in addressing health-related concerns.

ESSU identified **11 health-related institutional collaborations,** consisting of nine local partners, one national partner, and one global partner. At the local level, the University collaborates with Eastern Samar Provincial Hospital, Immaculate Concepcion Clinic and Hospital, Ponferrada Polymedic Hospital, Guiuan Rural Health Center, the Local Government Unit of Borongan City through its Rural Health Center, St. Jude Hospital, Borongan Doctors Hospital, Felipe Abrigo Memorial Hospital, and the Local Government Unit of Maydolong through its Rural Health Center.

These local partnerships underscore the University's engagement with healthcare providers and local government institutions in strengthening community-based health services. Through these institutional linkages, ESSU supports opportunities for health-related collaboration, community engagement, and the promotion of health and well-being among its stakeholders and surrounding communities.

Beyond its local partnerships, ESSU extends its institutional collaboration through Cebu Metro Psychiatry, Inc. (CMPI), representing its national-level engagement. At the global level, the University identifies Kkttongnae Philippines, Inc. (Pope Francis Complex Center for the Poor) as a partner, reflecting its broader institutional linkages in advancing health and social well-being initiatives.

The distribution of these collaborations demonstrates the University's strong local engagement while maintaining connections at national and global levels. In particular, the concentration of local partnerships provides an institutional foundation for responding to community health needs, while its wider collaborations create opportunities to exchange knowledge, strengthen institutional capacities, and extend the reach of health-related initiatives.

Collectively, these partnerships demonstrate ESSU's commitment to **current collaborations with local, national, or global health institutions to improve health and well-being outcomes,** contributing to the broader objectives of SDG 3: Good Health and Well-Being. They are particularly relevant to promoting mental health and well-being (Target 3.4), supporting health-related services and cooperation (Target 3.7), and strengthening partnerships that contribute to the achievement of the other relevant health targets.

Through these collaborations, ESSU reinforces its role as a public higher education institution that extends its contribution to sustainable development beyond academic instruction

and research by engaging with institutions that support the health and well-being of communities.

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL BEING

3.3.2 HEALTH OUTREACH PROGRAMMES



3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

3.3.2 HEALTH OUTREACH PROGRAMMES

Reporting Period: Calendar Year 2024 – 2025

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates its commitment to community health and well-being through outreach programmes and projects that address health education, gender-related health concerns, and food safety. These initiatives extend the University's services beyond its campuses, reaching local communities, disadvantaged groups, and individuals who may have limited access to health information and related services.

The two documented programmes illustrate complementary approaches to health promotion: community-based gender and health education and capacity-building on food safety. Together, these initiatives reached 450 beneficiaries, with the 2025 Gender and Health Fora accounting for 400 beneficiaries and the 2024 Food Safety: Health Education Series, Part II reaching 50 participants.

I. Summary of Health Outreach Programmes

Programme	Implementing campus/office	Date	Beneficiaries
Gender and Health Fora	Maydolong Campus Gender and Development Office	Nov. 28–Dec. 12, 2025	400
Food Safety: Health Education Series, Part II	Guiuan Campus College of Nursing, Medical and Dental Unit, and Gender and Development Office	March 8, 2024	50
		Total	**450**

II. Programme Details and Community Impact

A. Gender and Health Fora – Maydolong Campus

Particulars	Details
Implementing office	Gender and Development Office
Clientele	BPATS, BDACs, 4Ps beneficiaries, and high school students
Number of clients	400
Implementation period	November 28–December 12, 2025
Locations	Quinapondan; Soong, Llorente; Pedro E. Candido Memorial National High School; and Llorente Evacuation Center, Eastern Samar

The Gender and Health Fora brought health-related discussions and information directly to local communities, reaching 400 participants across several locations in Eastern Samar. By engaging BPATS, BDACs, 4Ps beneficiaries, and high school students, the programme provided opportunities to promote awareness of gender-responsive health and well-being concerns among different community groups.

Its implementation across community settings, including a high school and an evacuation center, demonstrates the University's efforts to extend health education beyond the campus and reach populations in different circumstances. The participation of 4Ps beneficiaries also provides an opportunity to address the health information needs of households participating in government poverty-reduction initiatives.

The programme illustrates ESSU's role in delivering outreach programmes and projects in the local community to improve or promote health and well-being, particularly through education and community engagement.

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BAGONG PILIPINAS

EXTENSION ACTIVITY DESIGN

Document ID: ESSU - AD

I. **Executive Summary**

A. **Title:** GENDER & HEALTH FORA

18 DAY CAMPAIGN TO END VAW

B. **Extension Program/Project Title:**

C. **Sustainable Development Goal/s:** SDG 3
SDG 5
SDG 17

D. **Type of Extension Activity**

Instruction: Check the appropriate box for the type of extension activity.
☑ Capacity Development
☐ Technical Assistance/Advisory Services
☐ Community Outreach/Volunteer/Charity Works
☐ Technical Assistance/Advisory Services
☐ Advocacy/Information Dissemination
☐ Technology Transfer and Commercialization
☐ Research-Based Intervention
☐ Others (please specify)

E. **Proponent/s:** GAD Office

- Implementing College/Campus/Office:
- Number of Faculty,Staff and Students Involved: 400
- Partner Agencies/Industry/Community Sector:

F. **Type and Number of Clientele/s:** BPATs, BOACs, 4Ps, High school students

G. **Target Date:** Start Date: November 28, 2025
End Date:December 12, 2025
12

H. **Total Amount of Hours Spent**

I. **Target Venue:** Quinapondan, ESamar (Nov. 28, 2025)
Soong, Llorente, ESamar (Dec. 1, 2025)
Pedro E. Candido Memorial National High School (December 4, 2025)
Evacuation Center, Llorente, ESamar (Dec. 12, 2025)

J. **Total Cost and Funding Source:** 500.00
From ESSU
From Partner Agency:

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BAGONG PILIPINAS

IV. **Implementation Plan**

Day/Time	Specific Activity	Responsible Person/In-Charge
November 28, 2025- Quinapondan, ESamar December 1, 2025 Soong, Llorente December 4, 2025 PEDNHMS, Hernani, ESamar December 12, 2025 Evacuation Center, Llorente, ESamar 8 AM – 5	Registration of participants Opening Program Invocation Philippine National Anthem Opening Remarks Rationale Talk 1: Gender And Development Talk 2: HIV Talk 3 : Safe Spaces Act Talk 4 : Anti Human Trafficking Talk 5: EO 70/ELCAC Talk 6: Child Protection Laws	 AVP AVP Dr. Jerald P. Torillo Campus Administrator ESSU-Maydolong Apolinario John Bocar GAD Focal ESSU – Maydolong ESSU-Maydolong RHU-Quinapondan, Llorente and Hernani PNP- Quinapondan, Llorente and Hernani MSWD- Quinapondan, Llorente and Hernani PNP- Quinapondan, Llorente and Hernani MSWD- Quinapondan, Llorente and Hernani

VI. **Management Team:**

Name	Position/Designation	Function/Role (e.g. Trainer or Resource Speaker; Consultant; Facilitator etc.)
Dr. Jerald P. Torillo	Campus Administrator	Consultant
Lalaine Lerma A. Ladiao	Director for Research & Extension	Consultant
Apolinario John Bocar	Head, Training and Extension Services Office	Proponent & Resource Person
Zedie Azura	Dean, College of Criminal Justice Education	Facilitator
Kimberly Contado	Program Head, BSCriminology	Facilitator

ESSU-TESO 200b | Version 6
Effectivity Date: June 23, 2025

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BAGONG PILIPINAS

GENDER AND HEALTH FORUM
December 1, 2025
Soong Covered Court
Soong, Llorente, ESamar

Aspect	Numerical Rating	Verbal Interpretation
1. Relevance and usefulness of the topic	5.0	Excellent
2. Completeness of the topic	5.0	Excellent
3. Attainment of the objectives	5.0	Excellent
4. Learning tools and materials used	5.0	Excellent
5. Resource speaker's mastery of the topic	5.0	Excellent
6. Resource speaker's clarity of discussion	5.0	Excellent
7. Resource speaker's ability to facilitate discussion and encourage participation	5.0	Excellent
8. Resource speaker's teaching Methodologies used	5.0	Excellent
9. Time management	5.0	Excellent
10. Venue is conducive to training	5.0	Excellent

Pre/Post Assessment of Knowledge and Skill

1. Knowledge or skills on the topic BEFORE the Training/Seminar	1.0	Very Limited
2. Knowledge or skills on the topic AFTER the Training/Seminar	5.0	Outstanding

Prepared by:

APOLINARIO JOHN A. BOCAR
Head, Training & Extension Services Office

Noted:

LALAINE LERMA A. LADIAO
Director for Research & Extension

Link to Evidence:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Y0iNZ0m9RjPNWVkQkLflKqZHv9eoHsmA/view

B. Food Safety: Health Education Series, Part II – Guiuan Campus

Particulars	Details
Implementing offices	College of Nursing, Medical and Dental Unit, and Gender and Development Office
Clientele	BPATS and food stall/establishment owners and employees in Barangay Salug, Guiuan, Eastern Samar
Number of clients	50
Date	March 8, 2024
Venue	ESSU Guiuan Function Hall

The Food Safety: Health Education Series, Part II demonstrates ESSU's contribution to promoting health and well-being through food safety education. The programme specifically engaged food stall and establishment owners and employees in Barangay Salug, Guiuan, Eastern Samar, recognizing the importance of safe food handling practices in protecting consumers and preventing foodborne illnesses.

Through the involvement of the College of Nursing, Medical and Dental Unit, and Gender and Development Office, the initiative reflects an interdisciplinary approach to community health promotion. Its focus on food safety extends the University's health education efforts to individuals whose daily work directly influences the health and safety of the consuming public.

By reaching 50 participants, the programme contributed to strengthening awareness of food safety as an important component of public health and community well-being.







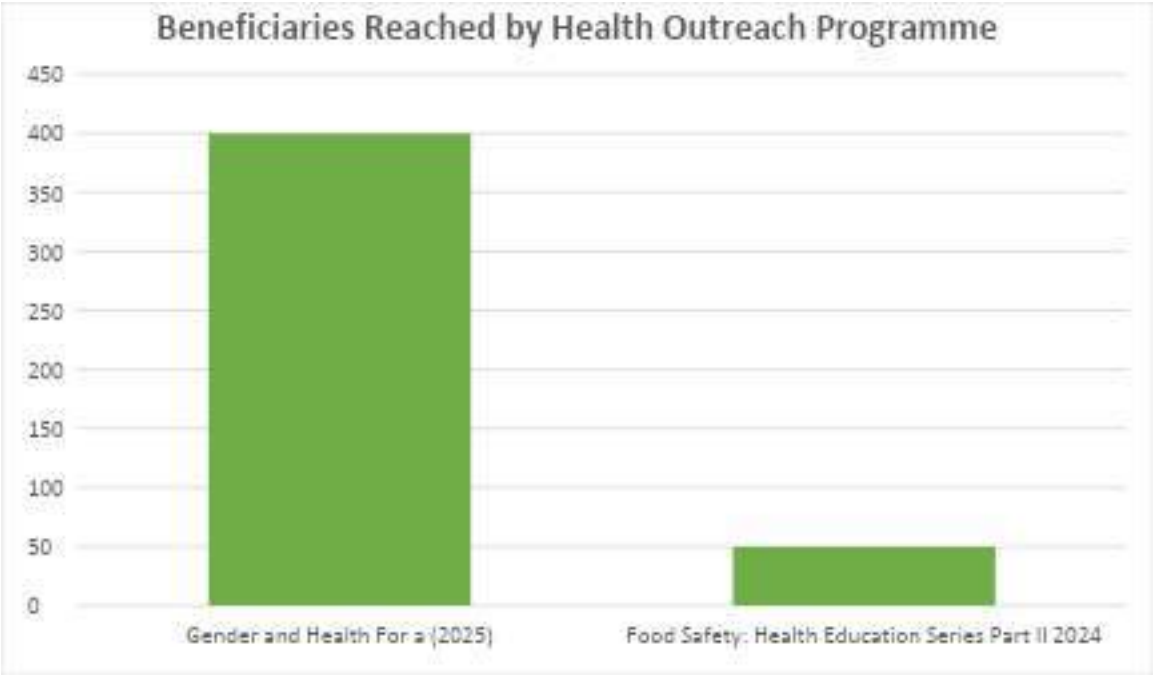


Link to Evidence:

[Activity Design]

[Attendance]

C. Interpretation of Programme Reach



The data show that the Gender and Health Fora reached eight times as many participants as the Food Safety Health Education Series. This indicates the substantial community reach of the 2025 initiative, particularly through its implementation in multiple localities.

Indicator	Gender and Health Fora	Food Safety Series
Beneficiaries	400	50
Percentage of total recorded beneficiaries	88.89%	11.11%
Community-based health education	Yes	Yes
Engagement beyond the university campus	Yes	Yes, through community-targeted participants

The combined reach of 450 participants illustrates the University's contribution to community health promotion through educational outreach. More importantly, the programmes address different dimensions of health and well-being, from gender-responsive health awareness to food safety and preventive health practices.

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) delivers outreach programmes and projects in **local communities** and among **disadvantaged people** to improve or promote health and well-being through health education, community engagement, and preventive health practices.

A significant initiative was the **Gender and Health Fora**, implemented by the Gender and Development Office of the Maydolong Campus from November 28 to December 12, 2025. The programme reached 400 participants, including BPATS, BDACs, 4Ps beneficiaries, and high school students. It was conducted in Quinapondan, Soong in Llorente, Pedro E. Candido Memorial National High School, and an evacuation center in Llorente, Eastern Samar.

The programme demonstrates ESSU's commitment to reaching **local communities** by bringing health-related discussions and information directly to different localities rather than limiting these initiatives to the University's campuses. Its engagement with 4Ps beneficiaries and other identified community groups also highlights the University's efforts to extend health education to **disadvantaged people**, particularly households and individuals who may experience socioeconomic barriers to accessing health information and services. Conducting the activity in an evacuation center further demonstrates the University's outreach beyond conventional educational settings and its responsiveness to community circumstances.

Another initiative was the **Food Safety: Health Education Series, Part II**, conducted by the Guiuan Campus through the College of Nursing, Medical and Dental Unit, and Gender and Development Office on March 8, 2024. The programme reached 50 participants, particularly BPATS and food stall and establishment owners and employees in Barangay Salug, Guiuan, Eastern Samar. It promoted food safety awareness among individuals whose daily practices directly affect public health and consumer welfare. This initiative further illustrates ESSU's engagement with local communities through health education and preventive health promotion.

With 400 beneficiaries reached through the 2025 Gender and Health Fora and an additional 50 participants in the 2024 Food Safety initiative, these programmes demonstrate ESSU's contribution to community-based health education and the promotion of healthier and safer communities.

Regarding refugee/immigrant communities, this component is not applicable to the University's documented local outreach context, as no recorded refugee or immigrant community has been identified in Eastern Samar for the reporting period. Accordingly, ESSU's documented contribution under this indicator primarily focuses on local communities and disadvantaged people.

Through these initiatives, ESSU reinforces its commitment to delivering outreach programmes and projects that improve or promote health and well-being, particularly among communities and population groups that benefit from accessible health information, preventive education, and institutional support. These efforts contribute to the University's broader commitment to SDG 3: Good Health and Well-Being.

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL BEING

3.3.3. SHARED SPORTS FACILITIES



3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

3.3.3. SHARED SPORTS FACILITIES

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) promotes inclusive access to sports and recreational opportunities by **providing free access to all its sports facilities**, including basketball courts, lawn tennis courts, open fields and grounds, and covered court. Through this arrangement, the University extends the use of its sports infrastructure beyond its regular academic and institutional activities, making these facilities available to support physical activity, recreation, sports development, and community engagement.

The University's commitment to sharing its facilities reflects its recognition that sports infrastructure serves not only the needs of enrolled students and university personnel but also the broader community. By providing access without charge, ESSU helps reduce financial barriers to participation in sports and recreational activities, particularly among individuals and groups who may have limited access to appropriate sporting venues. This arrangement reinforces the University's role as a public institution that maximizes its resources for the benefit of its surrounding communities.

Shared Sports Facilities

ESSU provides free access to the following sports and multipurpose facilities:

Sports facility	Access arrangement	Purpose and potential community benefits
Basketball Court	Free access	Supports basketball activities, physical fitness, recreational participation, and community sports engagement.
Lawn Tennis Court	Free access	Provides opportunities for tennis practice, sports skill development, and recreational physical activity.
Open Field/Grounds	Free access	Accommodates athletic activities, sports training, recreational activities, and organized sporting events.
Covered Court	Free access	Provides a venue for indoor sports, basketball, volleyball, physical activities, recreational programs, and community gatherings that promote social interaction and well-being.

Photographic Documentation of Sports Facilities

Photographic documentation is provided to establish the existence and availability of ESSU's sports facilities. The photographs illustrate the University's basketball court, lawn tennis court, covered court, and open field/grounds, which are made accessible free of charge.

These facilities represent the University's investment in sports infrastructure and its commitment to providing spaces that support physical fitness, recreation, and athletic participation. The documentation also demonstrates the University's capacity to accommodate various sports, physical activities, and recreational programs. By maintaining and making these facilities accessible, ESSU contributes to creating opportunities for students and members of the local community to participate in activities that promote health, physical well-being, and social interaction.



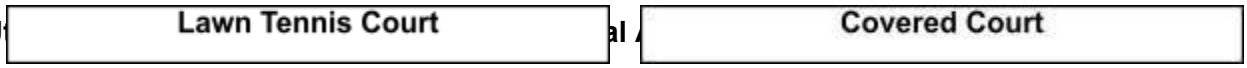
Open Field/Ground



Basketball Court







The University's Inter-Campus Meet demonstrates the utilization of its sports facilities for organized athletic activities. The event provides opportunities for students from different ESSU campuses to participate in sports competitions, develop athletic skills, and strengthen camaraderie and teamwork. Through these activities, the University maximizes the use of its sports infrastructure while promoting an active and health-conscious university community.

The availability of these facilities also provides opportunities for broader community participation in sports and recreational activities. Shared access to university facilities can strengthen relationships between ESSU and its surrounding communities by providing accessible spaces for physical activity, sports development, and social interaction.

Contribution to Sustainable Development

ESSU's provision of free access to its sports facilities contributes to the promotion of health and well-being by supporting physical activity, recreation, and opportunities for sports participation. It also advances inclusive community engagement by making university resources accessible without imposing financial barriers.

By opening its basketball courts, lawn tennis courts, covered courts, and open fields and grounds for shared use, the University reinforces its role as a public institution that extends the benefits of its resources beyond the campus and contributes to the welfare and development of the communities it serves.

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL BEING

3.3.4. SEXUAL AND REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH CARE SERVICES FOR STUDENTS



3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

3.3.4. SEXUAL AND REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH CARE SERVICES FOR STUDENTS

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU), through its College of Nursing and Allied Sciences (CONAS), in collaboration with the Student Services and Alumni Affairs (SSAA), provided students with access to sexual and reproductive health-care information and education services through the symposium titled “Health in Focus: Promoting Understanding and Exploring HIV, UTI, and Mental Health.” Conducted on November 8, 2024, at Canuctan Hall, ESSU Main Campus, the activity addressed essential health concerns, particularly HIV prevention, sexually transmitted infection awareness, and the promotion of informed health practices among students.

The symposium featured discussions led by BS Midwifery Program Head Mr. Jairus Ken A. Balagbis, who discussed HIV-related stigma and discrimination, modes of transmission, testing, and prevention strategies. Dr. Katrina Carmel Rapada of the Borongan City Rural Health Unit provided information on the causes, common signs and symptoms, management, and complications of urinary tract infections (UTIs). Meanwhile, psychometricians from the University Guidance Office discussed mental health awareness, addressing stigma, coping strategies, and building resilience.

The activity catered to first-year students representing the university's different colleges, demonstrating ESSU's effort to make essential health information accessible across its academic community. The inclusion of discussions on HIV transmission, testing, and prevention strengthened students' understanding of sexual and reproductive health concerns, while the participation of a health professional from the local government health unit reinforced the connection between university-based health education and community health services. Furthermore, the interactive question-and-answer session provided students with an opportunity to raise concerns, clarify misconceptions, and gain practical knowledge from the resource speakers.

Through this initiative, ESSU demonstrated its commitment to providing students access to sexual and reproductive health-care information and education services. By addressing HIV awareness, prevention, and stigma alongside other health and well-being concerns, the university contributed to informed decision-making, health literacy, and the reduction of discrimination among students. The activity also highlights the university's role in promoting preventive health education and empowering students to become more conscious of their personal health and well-being.

3.3.4 SEXUAL AND REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH CARE SERVICES FOR STUDENTS

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU), through its College of Nursing and Allied Sciences (CONAS), in collaboration with the Student Services and Alumni Affairs (SSAA), provided students with **free access to sexual and reproductive health-care information and education services** through the symposium titled *"Health in Focus: Promoting Understanding and Exploring HIV, UTI, and Mental Health,"* conducted on November 8, 2024, at Canuctan Hall, ESSU Main Campus.

The symposium addressed important health concerns, particularly HIV awareness, transmission, testing, prevention strategies, and the stigma and discrimination associated with the condition. Mr. Jairus Ken A. Balagbis, BS Midwifery Program Head, discussed HIV prevention and the importance of informed health practices. Dr. Katrina Carmel Rapada from the Borongan City Rural Health Unit provided information on urinary tract infections, including their causes, signs and symptoms, management, and possible complications. The activity also incorporated discussions on mental health, coping strategies, and resilience facilitated by psychometricians from the University Guidance Office.

The symposium catered to first-year students representing the university's different colleges, making essential health information accessible to a broader segment of the student population. Through expert-led discussions and an interactive question-and-answer session, students were given opportunities to clarify misconceptions, raise health-related concerns, and develop greater awareness of preventive measures. In particular, the discussions on HIV testing, transmission, and prevention contributed to improving students' understanding of sexual health, while addressing stigma and discrimination encouraged a more informed and supportive environment for individuals affected by HIV.

This initiative demonstrates ESSU's provision of **free access to sexual and reproductive health-care information and education services** as part of its commitment to student health and well-being. By making health education accessible across colleges and engaging both university personnel and an external health professional, ESSU strengthened students' health literacy and encouraged responsible health practices. The activity also highlights the university's preventive approach to health promotion, recognizing that access to accurate information and education is essential in enabling students to make informed decisions concerning their health.

Link to Evidence: https://www.facebook.com/share/p/19mq4tsdHD/


Health in Focus:
Promoting Understanding and
Exploring UTI, HIV, and Mental Health











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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL BEING

3.3.5 MENTAL HEALTH SUPPORT FOR STUDENTS



3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

3.3.5 MENTAL HEALTH SUPPORT FOR STUDENTS

Reporting Period: Academic Year 2024–2025

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU), through its Guidance and Counseling Services, **actively promotes good mental health among students** through information dissemination and activities that encourage emotional well-being and psychological self-care. During Academic Year 2024–2025, ESSU Guiuan implemented two free mental health promotion initiatives: the distribution of mental health information leaflets and a student wellness activity focused on personal renewal and healing.

These initiatives demonstrate the University's commitment to providing students with access to mental health information and promoting awareness of the importance of mental well-being. The activities also reflect an approach that combines preventive mental health education with opportunities for students to engage in wellness-oriented activities.

Mental Health Promotion Activities

Activity	Date and Implementation	Cost
Paghibaro ha Kahimsog han Hunahuna: Distribution of Mental Health Leaflets	January 27–February 3, 2025; room-to-room distribution of mental health leaflets	Free
Recharge and Renew: A Journey to Soulful Healing	February 7, 2025; ESSU Guiuan Covered Court	Free
Unshaken! Strengthening Student Resilience in Times of Crisis	October 29, 2025; Google Meet	Free

The first initiative, *Paghibaro ha Kahimsog han Hunahuna*, involved the room-to-room distribution of mental health leaflets from January 27 to February 3, 2025. Implemented by the Guidance and Counseling Services, this activity brought mental health information directly to students in their respective classrooms. This approach facilitated the dissemination of information on mental health and helped encourage students to recognize the importance of maintaining good mental well-being.

The second initiative, *Recharge and Renew: A Journey to Soulful Healing*, was conducted on February 7, 2025, at the ESSU Guiuan Covered Court. This activity provided an opportunity to promote mental wellness through a dedicated student-oriented activity emphasizing personal renewal and emotional well-being. By organizing a wellness activity

alongside information dissemination, the University demonstrated a broader approach to the active promotion of good mental health.

The third initiative, Unshaken! Strengthening Student Resilience in Times of Crisis, was conducted on October 29, 2025, through Google Meet. This initiative focused on strengthening student resilience in times of crisis, recognizing the importance of psychological preparedness and the capacity to cope with challenging circumstances. By utilizing an online platform, the University also extended its mental health promotion efforts beyond face-to-face campus activities, providing an alternative mode of engagement for students.

All three initiatives were implemented by the Guidance and Counseling Services at no cost. Providing these initiatives **free of charge** allowed students to participate in mental health promotion activities without financial barriers. Furthermore, the activities employed different approaches, including information dissemination, in-person wellness engagement, and online resilience-building initiatives. This demonstrates the University's efforts to make mental health promotion accessible and responsive to different student needs and circumstances.

Link to Evidence:

Paghibaro ha Kahimsog han Hunahuna: Distribution of Mental Health Leaflets

Recharge and Renew: A Journey to Soulful Healing

Unshaken! Strengthening Student Resilience in Times of Crisis

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3.3.6 SMOKE-FREE POLICY



3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

3.3.6 SMOKE-FREE POLICY

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates its commitment to protecting the health and well-being of its students, employees, and campus visitors through the implementation of a comprehensive smoke-free policy. Anchored in national legal provisions, including Civil Service Commission (CSC) Memorandum Circular No. 17, s. 2009, Republic Act No. 9211 (Tobacco Regulation Act of 2003), and CSC-DOH Joint Memorandum Circular No. 2010-01, the University's policy establishes a **complete smoking ban across all campus buildings, grounds, and university vehicles,** with no designated smoking areas.

The University's smoke-free policy covers cigarettes, electronic cigarettes (e-cigarettes), and other nicotine products. By extending the prohibition beyond conventional tobacco products, ESSU recognizes the importance of addressing emerging forms of nicotine consumption and preventing exposure to potentially harmful substances within the academic environment. The prohibition also extends to tobacco sponsorship in all University activities, reinforcing the University's commitment to maintaining an environment free from tobacco-related commercial influence and promotion.

Scope and implementation of the smoke-free policy

The following table presents the key provisions, coverage, and institutional mechanisms supporting the implementation of ESSU's smoke-free policy.

Complete Smoking Ban	Legal Basis / Responsible Unit	Institutional Provision and Implementation
Complete smoking ban	CSC MC No. 17, s. 2009; RA 9211	Prohibits smoking in all campus buildings, grounds, and university vehicles, with no designated smoking areas.
Products covered	University policy	Covers cigarettes, e-cigarettes, and other nicotine products, extending protection beyond conventional tobacco products.
Prohibition of tobacco sponsorship	CSC-DOH JMC 2010-01	Prohibits tobacco sponsorship in all University activities to prevent

		tobacco-related promotion and institutional associations.
Policy enforcement	Medical Services, Human Resource Management Office (HRMO), and Security Services	Designated institutional offices support policy implementation, monitoring, and enforcement.
Information and awareness	University administration and concerned offices	Signage is provided to inform students and employees about the smoking prohibition and reinforce compliance across the University.

Institutional impact and contribution to health and well-being

The implementation of a complete smoking ban contributes to a healthier, safer, and more conducive learning and working environment. By prohibiting smoking throughout university premises and vehicles, ESSU minimizes opportunities for exposure to secondhand smoke among students, faculty, non-teaching personnel, and visitors. The absence of designated smoking areas further strengthens the University's preventive approach by establishing a consistent smoke-free environment rather than limiting the prohibition to selected buildings or facilities.

The inclusion of e-cigarettes and other nicotine products reflects a broader institutional approach to tobacco and nicotine control. This provision is particularly relevant in educational settings, where protecting young people from exposure to tobacco products and discouraging nicotine use are important public health considerations. Similarly, the prohibition of tobacco sponsorship across all University activities helps ensure that academic, cultural, athletic, and institutional engagements are not used as platforms for tobacco-related promotion.

The involvement of the Medical Services, HRMO, and Security Services provides an institutional mechanism for implementing and reinforcing the policy. Meanwhile, the installation of signage serves as a visible reminder of the University's expectations and helps communicate the smoking prohibition to students and employees. These measures demonstrate that the policy is supported not only by formal legal provisions but also by institutional responsibilities and practical enforcement arrangements.

Overall, ESSU's smoke-free policy represents a preventive and institution-wide approach to promoting health and well-being. It supports the creation of an environment where members of the University community can study, work, and participate in institutional activities without unnecessary exposure to tobacco smoke. Beyond regulatory compliance, the policy contributes to health promotion, disease prevention, and the development of a campus culture that recognizes the importance of healthy lifestyle choices.













Posted smoke-free and tobacco-free signage within the university premises as part of the implementation of the university's smoke-free and tobacco-free policy.

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3.3.7 MENTAL HEALTH SUPPORT FOR STAFF



3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

3.3.7 MENTAL HEALTH SUPPORT FOR STAFF

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) recognizes that promoting the mental health and well-being of its employees requires a supportive working environment that addresses their social, economic, physical, and psychological needs. As an institution committed to the holistic welfare of its workforce, the University demonstrates its concern for employees through initiatives that encourage social support, promote physical wellness, and strengthen a sense of belonging within the university community.

The University's commitment to employee welfare is demonstrated through the establishment of the **ESSU Family Pantry**, an initiative by a faculty member from the College of Arts and Sciences, the community pantry aimed to extend assistance to contractual employees under Job Order (JO) contracts by providing essential goods and helping them save on their daily expenses. The initiative was further sustained through the generosity and collective contributions of fellow faculty members who shared essential goods for the benefit of their colleagues.

Although primarily a social and economic assistance initiative, the ESSU Family Pantry demonstrates the University's recognition of the relationship between financial security, social support, and employee well-being. By extending assistance to contractual personnel, the initiative helped ease immediate economic pressures and fostered an environment of compassion, solidarity, and mutual support. It also reflects an inclusive approach to employee welfare by recognizing the needs of personnel whose employment arrangements may expose them to greater economic uncertainty.

The University's commitment to promoting wellness is further demonstrated through **ESSU Hypes Up the Energy for Women's Month Zumba**, as part of the National Women's Month celebration. Held at the University grandstand, the activity brought together students and employees in an energizing physical fitness session that celebrated unity, strength, and women's empowerment. The University also announced that Zumba sessions would continue every Thursday throughout March, encouraging members of the ESSU community to remain physically active and participate in wellness-focused activities organized in connection with the University's Gender and Development initiatives.

Through this activity, ESSU provided employees with opportunities for physical exercise, social interaction, and collective participation in a positive institutional environment. Regular physical activity and meaningful social engagement can contribute to stress management, improved mood, and overall psychological well-being. By incorporating wellness activities into

its institutional celebrations, the University reinforces the importance of maintaining a healthy balance between professional responsibilities and personal well-being.

These initiatives are consistent with the principles of **Republic Act No. 11036, or the Mental Health Act of 2018.** Specifically, Section 24 requires educational institutions to develop policies and programs for students, educators, and other employees designed to raise awareness on mental health issues, identify and provide support and services for individuals at risk, and facilitate access, including referral mechanisms, to treatment and psychosocial support. Section 25 further requires employers to develop appropriate policies and programs on mental health in the workplace to raise awareness, correct stigma and discrimination, identify and support individuals at risk, and facilitate access to treatment and psychosocial support.

Furthermore, **Civil Service Commission Memorandum Circular No. 04, s. 2020, or the Mental Health Program in the Public Sector,** provides a policy framework for government agencies, including State Universities and Colleges, to promote overall mental wellness and provide an inclusive, conducive, and supportive work environment for public officials and employees. The guidelines recognize physical fitness, team building, stress management, peer counseling, support groups, and interest groups as important strategies for promoting employee well-being.

Taken together, ESSU's employee welfare and wellness initiatives illustrate the University's recognition that a healthy workforce is essential to institutional effectiveness and sustainability. The Family Pantry highlights the importance of social assistance and economic support in addressing circumstances that may contribute to employee stress, while the Women's Month Zumba activity demonstrates the value of physical wellness, social interaction, and collective participation in promoting a positive workplace environment.

Link to Evidence:

Legal foundation: Republic Act No. 11036 – Mental Health Act of 2018

Public sector policy: CSC Memorandum Circular No. 04, s. 2020 – Mental Health Program in the Public Sector

ESSU Family Pantry: Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Sets Up Own Community Pantry for Employees

Women's Month Zumba: ESSU Hypes Up the Energy for Women's Month Zumba – Official ESSU Website